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S/S-3 - Mr. Gilman

August 31, 1950

CA - Mr. Clubb

Principle Objectives of Discussions with the British and French Respecting Formosa.

The basic objective of our discussions on Formosa with the British and French is to narrow the areas of disagreement between this Government and the British and French Governments respecting Formosa to the point that we might all support the same course of action respecting the Island. Our maximum objective would of course be to get British and French understanding of and support for the measures taken by the United States with respect to Formosa as a result of the Korean crisis, to a degree where we should not stand alone in the event of a clash between American and Chinese Communist forces. The long-term objective is to strengthen our international position, now weak, respecting Formosa.

If this maximum objective proves impossible of attainment, we should endeavor to learn the minimum modifications of our present position which would enable the British and French Governments to support us.

In general, during the discussions we should seek to obtain the following: (1) military neutralization of Formosa during the Korean crisis, (2) British and French support for this inside and outside the UN, (3) at least moral support for the United States in the event that its forces become engaged in direct hostilities with the Chinese Communists in an effort to carry out its neutralization, and (4) clarification of points of agreement and difference respecting the long-term political status of Formosa, with the United States evincing readiness to have the matter considered by an appropriate organ of the United Nations for solution in an orderly and peaceful way.

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